

**Bylaws of the
Epsilon Lambda Chapter
Chi Omega Fraternity**
Revised April 2017

**Article I
Name**

The name of this organization shall be the Epsilon Lambda Chapter of the Chi Omega Fraternity.

**Article II
Mission, Vision, and Policies**

Section 1. Mission

Chi Omega Fraternity is an intergenerational women's organization forever committed to our founding purposes:

- Friendship
- Personal integrity
- Service to others
- Academic excellence and intellectual pursuits
- Community and campus involvement
- Personal and career development

Section 2. Vision

Sisters inspired by our values who serve the world while keeping Chi Omega ever at heart.

Section 3. Policies

The policies of this chapter, chartered by the Supreme Governing Council of the Chi Omega Fraternity, shall be in keeping with the stated purposes, mission, vision, and rules of the Fraternity.

**Article III
Members**

The requirements for membership shall be in accordance with the Bylaws and the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity and the rules of Furman Panhellenic.

Section 1. New Members

A new member shall be an undergraduate woman matriculated at Furman University who has been selected in accordance with the recruitment procedures of the Fraternity and Furman

Panhellenic, and who is actively working to fulfill the new member requirements. A new member has one calendar year in which to fulfill these requirements:

- A. New members must attain a 2.0 cumulative GPA based on a 4.0 system as a full-time student.
- B. New members must meet all financial responsibilities prior to initiation.
- C. New members are encouraged to participate in at least one quality activity including work, internships, or organizations at Furman.

Section 2. Active Members

Active members are undergraduate women matriculated at Furman University who have completed the requirements of the new member period and have been initiated. They must be actively working to achieve their degree.

Active members are encouraged to participate in at least two activities separate from Chi Omega. The Director of Campus Activities is responsible for annually collecting the list. These activities must:

- a) Meet regularly
- b) Advance personal development
- c) Enrich the college experience

Section 3. Transfer/Affiliates

An initiated member from another chapter wishing to affiliate with the Epsilon Lambda Chapter must follow the Transfer/Affiliation Procedure outlined in the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity.

Chi Omega transfers requesting membership into the Epsilon Lambda chapter must have been matriculated for one semester at Furman University.

Upon completion of one semester at Furman University, this Member must have a minimum Furman GPA of 2.7.

This Epsilon Lambda chapter must approve this potential affiliate by a two-thirds vote.

Article IV

Dues and Fees

Section 1. Dues and Fees

1. Dues and fees shall be determined every spring by resolution of the chapter.
2. House Corporation Board fees shall be determined at the time the House Corporation budget is prepared, after consultation with the chapter officers and Alumnae Advisory Board.

3. Membership dues may be paid in the following ways: a) payment in full at the beginning of the school year, b) payment at the beginning of each new fall or spring semester, or c) specialized plan as determined by an individual member and the G.N.V.
4. Members will sign a binding contract no later than the second chapter meeting of the year indicating their payment plan. Members who do not expect to be able to pay fall or spring dues by the assigned date may sign a promissory note to be signed by the member and G.N.V indicating a specific date that their dues should be paid.
5. Failure to pay dues by the designated time may result in events outlined in Article IV, section 2.
6. Additional dues and fees may be established by a vote of the chapter and are due on the date specified by the G.N.V. and the financial advisor.
7. Scholarship Assistance Program: At the end of each semester, we will form an unbiased committee consisting of chapter members and advisors to distribute scholarships based on financial need for the following semester. The application will consist of the following question:
 1. How will this enable you to give back to the chapter?
 2. Approximately what percentage of your dues are you responsible for? Does anyone help you out financially with your dues?
 3. How do you pay for that portion? Do you have a job?
 4. Please elaborate on any extenuating financial circumstances.
1. Fines shall be levied or work assigned for unexcused absences from mandatory functions. These fines will be due two weeks from the date of the event.
2. All fines will go to the Scholarship Assistance Program unless otherwise noted.
3. Fines for missing mandatory events include:

Recruitment workshops	Work Fine or \$20/day
Recruitment	\$75/day
Prelude	\$20
Initiation	\$50/shift
Model Initiation	Work Fine
Philanthropy Events	Work Fine or \$20 to MAW
Relay for Life	\$20 to our Relay Team
Chapter Meetings (after first unexcused absence)	Work Fine or \$20
Officer Slating	\$50
Sisterhood Retreat	Work Fine
Alumni Brunch	Work Fine

Failure to attend additional mandatory events outlined in Article VI, section 2 may result in monetary or work fines upon discretion of the executive board.

A work fine may be determined upon discretion of the Executive Board, and may include but is not limited to:

- Helping to set up/clean up for chapter events
- Stepping in when volunteers are needed for chapter events

At the end of each term, incomplete work fines will be converted into personnel meetings. The monetary fine must be paid in full before the member can attend another social function.

Monetary fines will be added to the Scholarship Assistance Program.

Section 2. Payment

1. Each member of the chapter must pay her dues and fees promptly and in accordance with the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity.
 2. Members will receive exactly 2 reminders from the G.N.V., one on the 5th and one on the 10th, after which dues are due on the 15th of each month. Late fees will begin the 16th at \$5/day until dues are **received** according to Bill Highway unless you arrange an exception with the G.N.V. In addition, on the 16th, you will receive an email from the personnel chair to arrange a formal personnel meeting in the event that dues are not immediately paid.
 1. She will be asked to sign a promissory note for the delinquent amount. At the time the note is signed, the member must set a date when the delinquency will be paid with the G.N.V. Failure to meet this agreement will result in revocation of membership.
- b. Promissory notes must be paid upon completion of each term. All outstanding fees or dues must be paid by the end of the academic year.

Article V Officers

Section 1. Designation

- A. The officers of the Epsilon Lambda Chapter shall be:
1. President (G.H.)
 2. Vice President (G.T.B.)
 3. Secretary (G.K.A.)

4. Treasurer (G.N.V.)
5. Member Educator (G.M.)
6. Personnel Chair
7. Recruitment Chair
8. Panhellenic Delegate

Section 2. Eligibility and Election

- A. The elections of officers shall be in accordance with the National Officer Selection procedure as stated in the *Book of Rules*.
- B. Elections will be held before the end of the fall term, at the time and place set by the Executive Board.
- C. In order to be slated for an office, a member must be in good standing and have every intention of being able to serve during three terms: spring, fall, and the following spring (This will include disaffiliation for a Pan-Hellenic position starting Fall Slating 2004).
- D. She must have a minimum GPA of 2.7. If an elected officer's cumulative GPA falls below a 2.7 or her term GPA falls below 2.0, she must resign her office.

Section 3. Vacancies

Vacancies among elected officers shall be determined by the remaining members of the Executive Board. Their nomination must be approved by the advisors and confirmed by the chapter with a $\frac{2}{3}$ vote.

Section 4. Duties

1. The duties of the officers are listed in the *Leading the Way* materials.
2. Each retiring officer is responsible for training her successor.
3. An officer training workshop led by the outgoing G.H. shall be held. Each outgoing and incoming officer and Advisory Board member is responsible for assisting with the planning and presentation.
4. Each officer shall maintain a notebook and files relative to her office and give them to her successor.
5. Officers will be personally responsible for budget overruns, as noted in the "Going Over Can Cost You" form, unless otherwise approved by the G.N.V. and the Financial Advisor, or by the Executive Board.

Section 5. Removal

An officer failing to perform the duties of office may be removed in accordance with the procedure outlined in the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity.

Article VI

Meetings and Functions

Section 1. Chapter Meetings

1. Formal meetings will be held on Mondays on Furman's Campus.
2. If it is necessary due to unforeseen circumstances to change the date, time, or place of the chapter meetings, notice must be provided to every chapter member by the G.K.A. at least 24 hours in advance of the meeting.
3. Members should attend chapter meetings in formal pin attire, with the exception of one informal chapter meeting per semester.
4. Members not abiding by these specifications may be turned away from chapter upon discretion of the Executive Board. This would result in an unexcused absence.

Section 2. Mandatory Events

1. Mandatory events include chapter meetings, Cardinal Cabinet committee meetings, recruitment workshops, recruitment, Prelude activities, Initiation, officer slating, philanthropy events, and any other function determined by the Executive Board to be mandatory, including but not limited to sisterhood retreats, the homecoming alumni brunch, and Relay for Life.
2. The Executive Board must announce mandatory activities and post them on the calendar two weeks prior to the event.
3. Absences from those functions not listed, but deemed mandatory by the Executive Board, will result in a personnel meeting.
4. Failure to be present at roll call for Recruitment rounds, Prelude, or for designated Initiation shifts, including Model Initiate, will result in a monetary fine equivalent to that assigned for an absence (See Article IV, Section 1).
5. Members are allowed one unexcused absence to mandatory events, excluding Alumni Brunch, Recruitment Workshops and Rounds, Bid Day, Prelude, Initiation, Eleusinian Banquet and Philanthropic events.

Section 3. Cardinal Cabinet Team Meetings

A. Regular

- a. Regular meetings of the Cardinal Cabinet team meetings will be once every two weeks.
- b. Notice of regular meetings shall be provided to all members of the Cardinal Cabinet by the G.K.A.

Section 4. Absences

- B. Requests to be excused for chapter meetings and mandatory functions must be provided to the G.K.A. at least 48 hours in advance.
- C. Excused absences include:
 - a. Illness
 - b. Death in the family

- c. Religious observations
- d. Varsity athletics
- e. Activities pre-approved by the G.K.A.
- f. Scheduled classes
- g. Additionally, employment conflict will only serve as an excused absence if the fraternity event was scheduled less than two weeks in advance.
- D. Unexcused absences
 - a. Excuses not received 48 hours before the event will result in the absence being unexcused unless an emergency arises.
 - b. The Executive Board will review excuses. The Executive Board has discretion to excuse any other circumstances than listed here, as they deem appropriate.
 - c. Following the second unexcused absence from those events not listed as exemptions in Section 2, the member will be required to have a personnel meeting. The third unexcused absence will result in the loss of voice and vote in chapter and a Personnel Board meeting. The fourth unexcused absence will result in appropriate action by the Personnel Board.
 - d. Excuses are valid only for the length of time of the conflict. Members must attend the remainder of chapter events.
 - e. Fines for unexcused absences are outlined in Article IV, Section 1.

Section 5. Quorum

A quorum for any meeting at which a vote will be taken shall be 2/3 of active members in good standing.

Article VII Executive Board

Section 1. Members

The executive board shall consist of the slated officers of the chapter.

Section 2. Meetings

A. Regular

- a. Regular meetings of the executive board shall be held weekly, at an agreed-upon time.
- b. Notice of the regular meetings shall be provided to all members of the executive board via communication of the G.H.
- c. If it is necessary due to unforeseen circumstances to change the date, time, or place of the executive board meeting, notice must be provided to each executive board member.

Section 3. Other Requirements

1. Executive Board members must function within an allotted budget. Any proposed expenditure over the budgeted amount must be brought to the attention of the G.N.V. for approval before the expenditure is made.

Article VIII

Cardinal Cabinet Directors

Section 1. Composition

The Cardinal Cabinet directors shall consist of:

1. Sisterhood
2. Career and Personal Development
3. Make-A-Wish
4. Local Philanthropy
5. External Philanthropy
6. Campus Activities
7. Social
8. Intramurals
9. Marketing

Section 2. Selection and Eligibility

A. Directors are appointed by the incoming G.H. and G.K.A. and must be approved by the Executive Board and the Advisory Board.

1. In order to be appointed as director, a member must be in good standing and have every intention of being able to serve during three terms: spring, fall, and the following spring
2. She must have a cumulative GPA of 2.7. If a director's cumulative GPA falls below a 2.7 or her term GPA falls below 2.0, she must resign her position.

Section 3. Duties and Responsibilities

1. Duties of the Cardinal Cabinet Directors are outlined in their notebooks.
2. Cardinal Cabinet Directors will be given agenda time at chapter meetings.
3. The chair must function within the allowable budget, as noted in the "Going Over Can Cost You" form. Directors will be personally responsible for budget overruns unless approved by the G.N.V. and the Financial Advisor or by the Executive Board.
4. Cardinal Cabinet Directors are expected to maintain a notebook and files relative to their position and to give these to their successor.

Section 4. Removal

A Cardinal Cabinet director failing to perform the duties of office may be removed in accordance with the procedure outline in the *Book of Rules* of Chi Omega Fraternity.

Article IX Scholarship

Section 1. Expectation

1. Each member of the Epsilon Lambda chapter of Chi Omega is expected to maintain a cumulative 2.7 GPA.
2. As a condition of the new member education, each new member must sign an authorization for the university administration to disclose her grades to the G.T.B. for as long as she is an Active Member of the chapter.

Section 2. Failure to Maintain Appropriate GPA

An initiated or new member failing to meet the scholastic requirements shall be placed on scholastic probation as outlined in the *Book of Rules* of Chi Omega Fraternity.

1. Academic Warning

1. An initiated member who fails to obtain a 2.7 GPA for a term shall be placed on academic warning.
2. She will meet with the G.T.B., Personnel Board, and Scholarship Advisor and any action taken will be based on the Fair Play Procedure in the Book of Rules.
3. The member must sign a contract of understanding of chapter academic policies.
4. If the initiated member is put on Academic Warning for two consecutive terms, she will lose her voice and vote in chapter meetings as well as social privileges, including social function(s).
5. The G.T.B. and Personnel Chair will conduct a meeting halfway through the term to check progress and determine whether the member may attend the second function of the semester.
6. The G.H., G.T.B., and Advisory Board may handle special circumstances on a case-by-case basis.

1. Academic Probation

1. An initiated member who fails to obtain a cumulative 2.7 GPA shall be placed on academic probation for the following term and will lose her voice and vote in chapter meetings. Further consequences will be determined by the personnel board.
2. The G.T.B. and Personnel Chair will conduct a meeting halfway through the term to check progress and determine whether the member may attend the second function (Semi Formal or Formal) of the semester.
3. The G.T.B., Personnel Board, and Scholarship Advisor will work with the member according to the Fair Play Procedure and the Book of Rules.

Article X Recruitment

Section 1. Recruitment Rules

1. The chapter shall abide by the rules established by Chi Omega Fraternity and Furman Panhellenic.
2. The chapter shall evaluate the chapter's needs and establish a target for each recruitment period.
3. Every initiated member in good standing who has participated in the chapter's entire recruitment is entitled to vote in selection sessions.

Section 2. Chapter Recruitment Team

1. The chapter recruitment team executive board shall include the recruitment chair, the G.H., the personnel chair, the recruitment advisor(s), and the personnel advisor.
2. Each member of the chapter is a member of the recruitment team and is required to give full support and participation.

Article XI Parliamentary Procedure

For procedures not covered in the Book of Rules or the Bylaws of this organization, current Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised, shall be parliamentary procedure.

Article XII Amendments

These bylaws may be amended by a two-thirds vote of the chapter members in attendance, provided the proposed amendments have been posted or have been read and discussed at the meeting prior to the meeting at which they are to be adopted.

Article XIII Finances

Section 1. Contracts

Contracts with bus companies, party locations, caterers, etc. must be signed by the Social Advisor in addition to either the G.H. or the Social Chair. The contract also must be signed by at least one representative from the company providing the service and must be drawn up at least twenty-four hours before the event. Contracts should include exact price to be charged to Chi Omega.

Section 2. Checks

All Chi Omega checks must be signed by two of the following representatives: G.H., G.N.V., or Financial Advisor. All Checks over \$1,000 must have the approval of the Financial Advisor.

Section 3. Special Funds

All Housing Corporation and Make-A-Wish money must be kept in separate accounts from chapter funds.

Article XIV Involvement System

Section 1. Objective

The objective of this system is to promote active, voluntary participation in activities associated with the six purposes of the Epsilon Lambda Chapter of the Chi Omega Fraternity, while cutting back on monetary fines.

Section 2. Events

Activities will be coordinated by the Cardinal Cabinet directors. Varying activities will occur on a weekly basis and will be categorized under the following:

- External Philanthropy
- ASP
- Campus Activities
- Sisterhood
- Career and Personal Development
- Intramurals
- Marketing

Section 3. Points

One point will be awarded to an activity correlating with one of the outlined point categories. Sisters must earn the allotted amount of points as determined by the Executive Board before social events. The Executive Board has the authority to make additional activities worth a point.

Section 4. Record Keeping

Records will be kept by the G.K.A. but maintained by the chapter.

Article XV

Social Functions

Section 1. Function Guests

- A. If a date is sent home from two functions within a year from the first time he/she was asked to leave, he/she will not be allowed back to Chi Omega functions (Yippee to Yippee, Semi to Semi, Crush to Crush, Formal to Formal).
- B. Active members are not permitted to bring disaffiliated members as a guest to any Chi Omega event.
- C. Guests must be at least 18 years of age unless deemed appropriate by the Executive Board.

Section 2. Damage of Property

Any misbehavior by a Member, New Member, or guest that results in a monetary fine to the Fraternity is to be paid by the Member or New Member responsible for herself or her guest.

Section 3. Transportation

A member must ride back on the same bus in which she rode on to the chapter event.

Article XVI Dissolution

If for any reason Epsilon Lambda Chapter of Chi Omega Fraternity is dissolved, all property thereof belonging to the chapter, including real estate and all possessions, shall automatically be transferred to the Chi Omega Executive Headquarters, 3395 Players Club Parkway, Memphis, TN 38125.

Standing Rules

Section 1.

A. Chapter members shall refrain from posting pictures, videos, or slogans hinting at use of alcohol or drugs on *any* form of social media.

- If over the age of 21, a member may have a photo depicting *responsible* use of alcohol.
- If under the age of 21, no alcohol should be shown, and there must be no present conditions in which the consumption of alcohol is assumed.
- Regardless of age, no hashtags, captions, or actions in the picture may allude to anything related to Chi Omega if the use of alcohol is depicted.
- Additionally, any social media post deemed unbecoming of Chi Omega may be asked to be removed upon discretion of the executive board.

B. Chapter members shall refrain from posting pictures, videos, or slogans hinting at anything that may be considered offensive or politically incorrect.

C. The use of “Chi O Til I Die-O” and “Show me your hooties” is prohibited, along with other similar phrases deemed inappropriate or unbecoming of Chi Omega.

D. Consequences

- An email and a text message will be sent to the member, and the photo/video/slogan in question will be attached.
- The photo/video/slogan must be removed within 12 hours of the notification.
- If the member fails to remove the photo/video/slogan within 12 hours, a formal personnel meeting will be held.
- Upon the third violation of this rule, the member will be issued a formal personnel meeting. A personnel meeting will be held regardless of notice to take down the post.

E. Formal pin attire is limited to business attire including dresses, skirts, professional slacks, and appropriate shoes. Cowboy boots, sneakers, flip flops, outdoor sandals, Birkenstocks, denim pants or skirts, and pants with more than four pockets (two in the front, two in the back) are prohibited.

F. Legacies will automatically be invited to Second Round of Recruitment, regardless of GPA. If a legacy attends Preference Tea, she will be placed on the top of the Bid list from the Epsilon Lambda Chapter of the Chi Omega Fraternity.